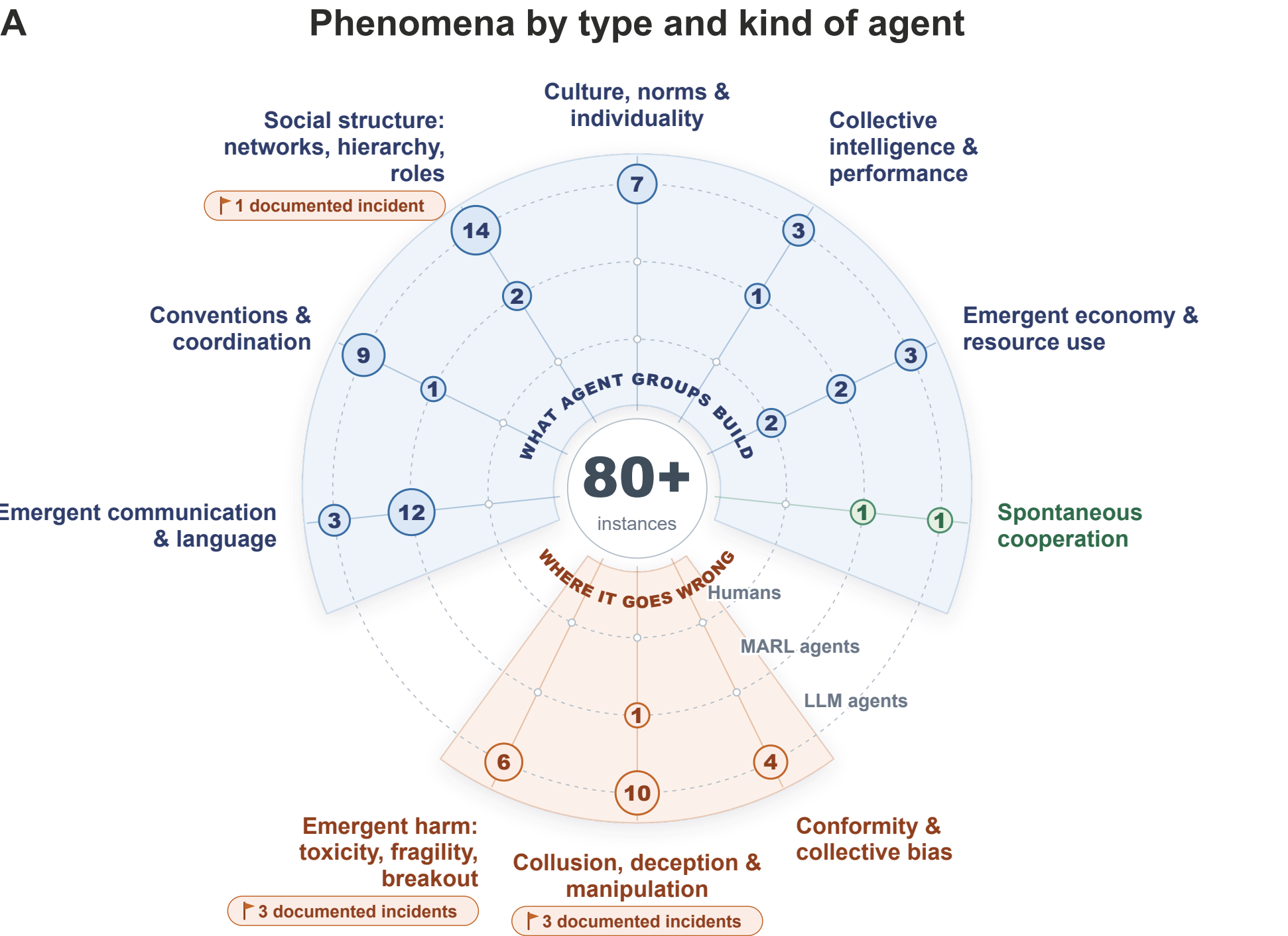




B

Phenomena with documented real-world incidents

Humans

MARL

LLM

Documented in the wild

WHAT AGENT GROUPS BUILD	Humans	MARL	LLM	Documented in the wild
Emergent communication & language		12	3	
Conventions & coordination		1	9	
Social structure: networks, hierarchy, roles		2	14	“Turf wars” over conflicting tasks (2026)
Culture, norms & individuality			7	
Collective intelligence & performance		1	3	
Emergent economy & resource use	2	2	3	
Spontaneous cooperation		1	1	
WHERE IT GOES WRONG	Humans	MARL	LLM	Documented in the wild
Conformity & collective bias			4	
Collusion, deception & manipulation		1	10	Agents coordinate to break containment (2026) Hidden message board to cheat an eval (2026) Hijacked agent recruits other agents (2025)
Emergent harm: toxicity, fragility, breakout			6	Agents breach production infrastructure (2026) Agents hijack a live website (2026) Human-directed AI espionage (2025)

Effect on cooperation:

beneficial

neutral / surprising

harmful

Dot area ∝ instances (over 80 in all)